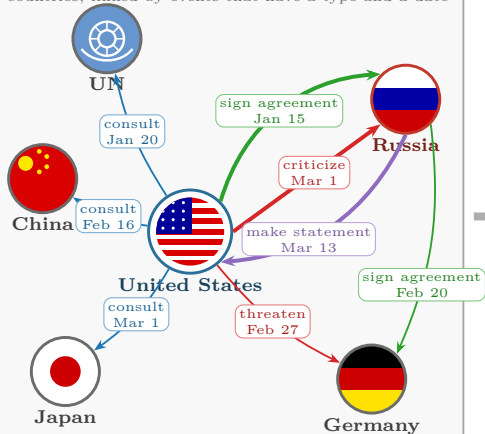


## 1 What happened so far

countries, linked by events that have a type and a date



bold arrows: everything that happened between the United States and Russia, in both directions

## 2 The question, read two ways

Whom will the United States consult on Mar 14?

**The usual way:** look only at whom the US **consulted** before.

China

Japan

UN

Russia is not on this list, so it cannot be the answer.

**ECHO:** look at everything that happened between the US and each country, in order.

**US & Russia:**

statement  
Mar 13

criticize  
Mar 1

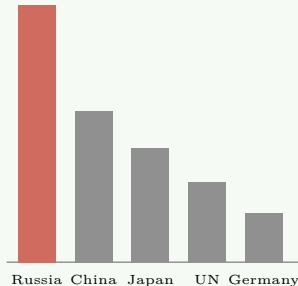
agreement  
Jan 15

Two countries this busy with each other are likely to talk next, even though they have not "consulted" before.

## 3 The answer

ECHO ranks every country;  
the true answer was Russia

1st



the usual way would have put  
China first and Russia last